

Narcissistic Leaders

Research: Michael Maccoby (2004)

Source: Harvard Business Review – R0401J-PDF-ENG

Key Insight:

Narcissistic leaders are often visionary and ambitious, driving innovation and bold strategies. However, they can also be hypersensitive to criticism, resist feedback, and create toxic work environments if unchecked

Takeaways:

- Productive narcissism drives confidence, charisma, and risk-taking.
- Unproductive narcissism results in arrogance, poor listening, and defensiveness.
- Balancing narcissism with emotional intelligence is crucial for leadership effectiveness

Relevance to OB:

This study highlights how personality traits influence leadership behavior, aligning perfectly with the "Personality Dynamics at Work" module. It shows the double-edged nature of narcissism in modern organizations.

Narcissism and the Entrepreneurial Personality

Research: Mathieu & St-Jean (2013)

Source: Personality and Individual Differences Journal

Key Insight:

Entrepreneurs often display narcissistic traits such as boldness and vision. While these traits may fuel innovation and confidence, excessive narcissism can lead to impulsive decisions and team conflict.

Takeaways:

- Moderate narcissism is associated with entrepreneurial success.
- High narcissism increases the risk of reckless behavior and unstable relationships.
- Personality assessment helps in designing resilient startup teams and managing founder dynamics

Relevance to OB:

This research expands our understanding of how narcissistic personality traits shape behavior in high-pressure, high-uncertainty environments—linking directly to organizational behavior in entrepreneurial contexts